OUR LADY OF FATIMA UNIVERSITY

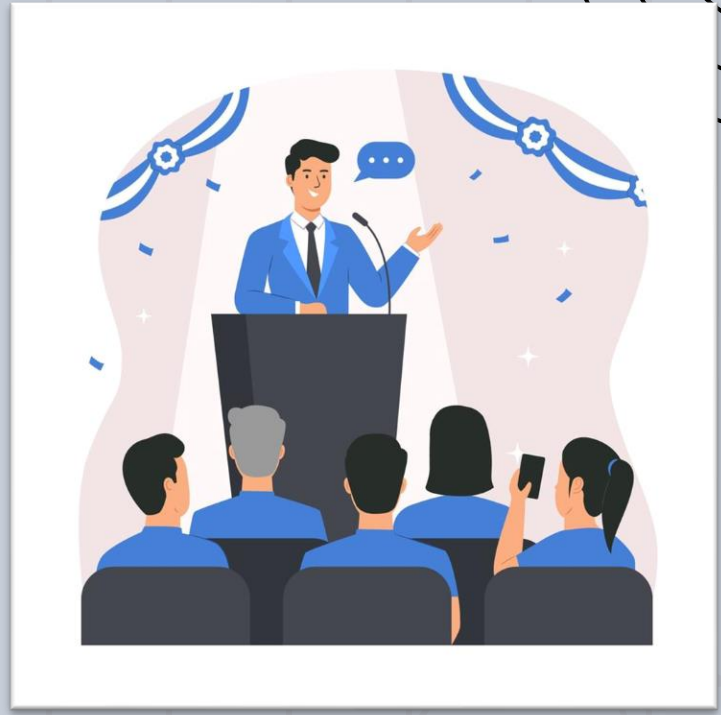
Communication for Information & Persuasion

Purposive Communication (PURC111)

Week 13

Agenda

- Communication to Inform
- Communication to Persuade
- Modes of Persuasion
- Monroe’s Motivated Sequence



Communication to INFORM

An **informative communication** is a written or spoken communication that **conveys knowledge or ideas to audience in order to develop understanding about a specific topic.**

Communication to INFORM

The purpose of **informative communication** is to...

- ***promote understanding***
- ***stimulate thinking***
- ***explain ideas***
- ***illustrate, define, describe a topic***

Communication to INFORM

Written, spoken, and visual informative communication can emerge from ***a range of categories:***

OBJECT	conveys knowledge about any inanimate object
PEOPLE	focuses on real or fictional individuals
CONCEPT	focuses on abstract and complex ideas
EVENT	focuses on current or past events
PROCESS	provides a step-by-step account of a procedure or natural occurrence
ISSUE	provides objective and balanced information about a disputed subject or matter.

Methods of INFORMATIVE COMMUNICATION

Definition

- explains the meaning of a term, concept, or idea
- can be **formal** (dictionary-style) or **informal** (context-based)
- to **clarify terms and establish a foundation** for further information

Demonstration

- shows how something is done or how it works
- provides **step-by-step guide**, with hands-on examples
- effective in **teaching practical skills** (e.g., cooking, crafting)

Methods of INFORMATIVE COMMUNICATION

Process Analysis

- **breaks down a process** into a series of steps or stages
- explains each step in detail **for clarity**
- for example, a process analysis could explain the steps in manufacturing a product or how a plant grows from a seed

Causal Analysis

- examines **cause-and-effect relationships**
- answers **"why"** something happened or predicts future outcomes
- focuses on **understanding the reasons** behind events, behaviors, or trends

Methods of INFORMATIVE COMMUNICATION

Comparison and Contrast

- highlights **similarities and differences** between subjects
- deepens understanding by juxtaposing features
- examples include: comparing historical events, product options, or scientific theories

Classification and Division

- organizes items **into categories**
- breaks down **a whole into component parts**
- helps simplify complex topics by showing structure and relationships

Tips for INFORMATIVE COMMUNICATION

1. **Analyze the audience.**
   - Never assume that your audience has a thorough background of the topic.
2. **Use appropriate language.**
   - Consider the standards of speaking and writing styles of your audience
3. **Explain the importance of the topic.**
   - Your audience should find a good reason to listen or read your message.

Tips for INFORMATIVE COMMUNICATION

4. **Express interest in the subject material.**
   - By expressing your own interest to the topic, you signal your audience that the material is valuable
5. **Show, do not tell.**
   - Descriptions, demonstrations and visual aids, and using available technology can enhance understanding of the topic.
6. **Be specific.**
   - Communicate about details rather than general ideas.

Communication to PERSUADE

Persuasion means trying to influence the way someone thinks or believes.

Persuasive communication is a kind of communication that attempts **to influence** the audience to adopt a perspective on a specific topic and **to act** upon that belief.

Communication to PERSUADE

Every persuasive communication expresses a particular **proposition.**

- A **proposition** is a statement or assertion that **expresses a judgment or opinion.**
- It is a claim that something is ***true or not, right or wrong, beneficial or necessary or otherwise.***

Communication to PERSUADE

Proposition of Fact

- when you try to establish that something is **"true or false."**

examples:

- **Climate change is primarily caused by human activity.**
- **Vaccines reduce the spread of infectious diseases.**
- **The universe is expanding.**

Communication to PERSUADE

Proposition of Value

- when you persuade an audience that something is **"good or bad," "right or wrong,"** or **"desirable or undesirable."**

examples:

- **Public education is more important than private schooling.**
- **Free healthcare is a moral obligation.**
- **Brat by Charli XCX is the best pop album released this year.**

Communication to PERSUADE

Proposition of Policy

- when you advocate that something **"should or should not"** be done.

examples:

- **Schools should implement mandatory mental health education for students.**
- **Plastic bags should be banned in all retail stores.**
- **Abortion should be legalized and accessible to all women, regardless of age or economic status.**

Modes of Persuasion

Persuasive communication involves three modes.

- **Ethos** – credibility
- **Pathos** – emotion
- **Logos** – logic

Modes of Persuasion

Ethos

- used to show the **character** of the speaker as **credible and trustworthy.**
  - **build your credibility**
  - **establish authority**
  - **use credible sources**

Modes of Persuasion

"As a licensed physician with over 20 years of experience in women's health, I have seen firsthand the critical importance of accessible reproductive care. Based on extensive research and medical practice, I strongly believe that all women deserve the right to make informed decisions about their own healthcare, including the choice to seek an abortion."

Modes of Persuasion

Modes of Persuasion

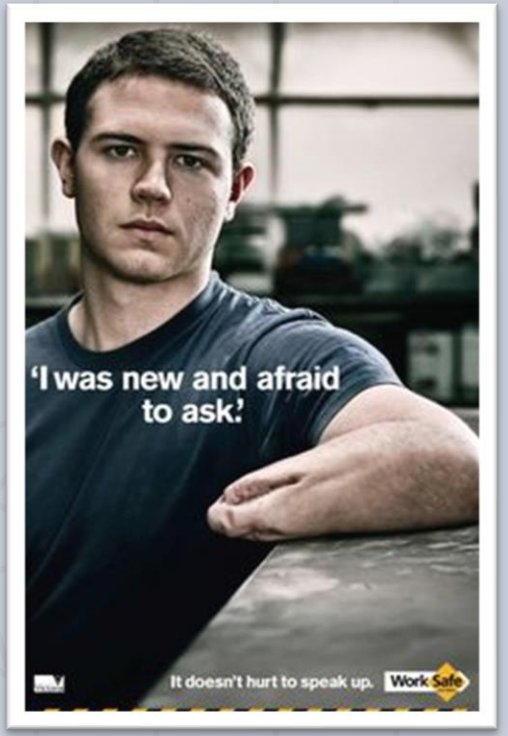
Pathos

- ***appeal to feelings or emotion***
- means to persuade an audience by purposely evoking certain emotions **to make them feel the way the author wants them to feel.**
    - **choose emotionally evocative words or phrases**
    - **use stories that evoke emotion.**

Modes of Persuasion

"Imagine being a young woman, scared and alone, facing an unplanned pregnancy with no support from family or friends. You have dreams and aspirations, but now your future seems uncertain. Without access to safe and legal abortion, your entire life could be changed forever. No one should be forced to carry a pregnancy against their will."

Modes of Persuasion



Modes of Persuasion

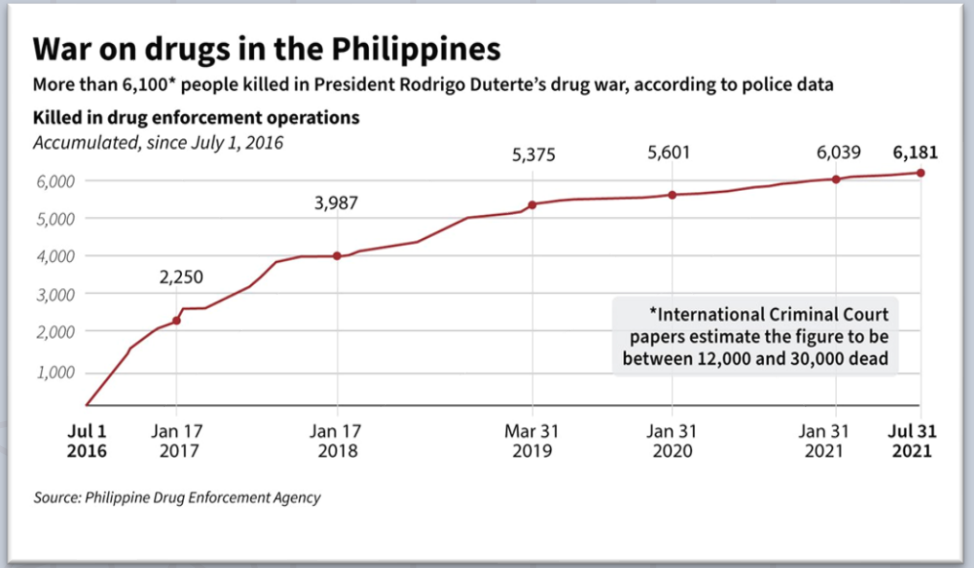
Logos

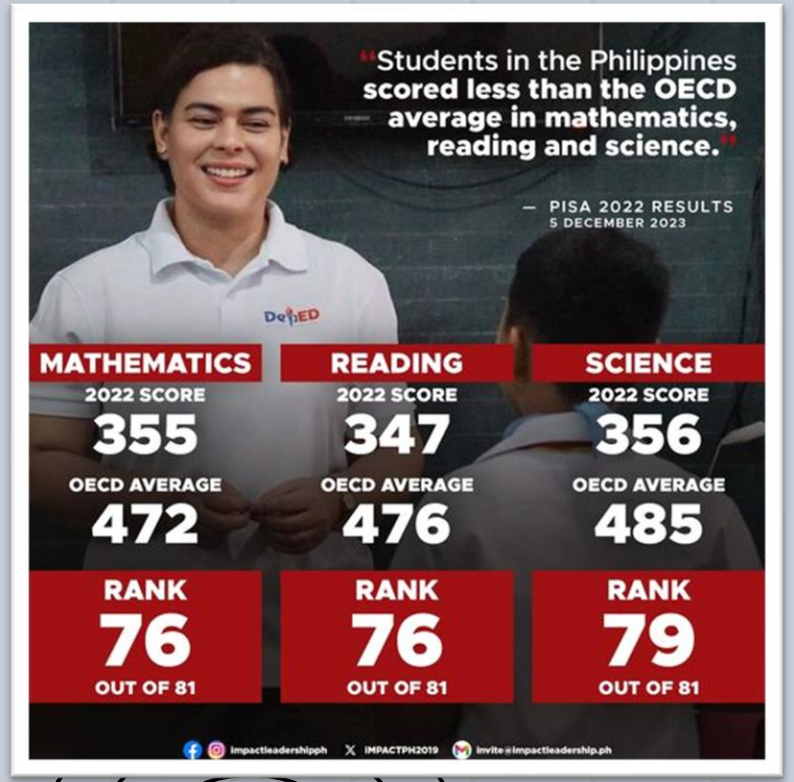
- or **the appeal to logic,** means to appeal to the audiences' sense of reason.
  - **make clear and logical connections between ideas**
  - **use factual and logical evidences, such as statistics**
  - **avoid logical fallacies**

Modes of Persuasion

"Studies show that regions with access to safe and legal abortion services have lower maternal mortality rates. According to the World Health Organization, countries with restrictive abortion laws often experience higher rates of unsafe, illegal procedures that result in preventable deaths. In contrast, countries with comprehensive reproductive health policies have seen significant improvements in women's health outcomes and overall well-being."

Modes of Persuasion





Monroe's Motivated Sequence

Monroe's Motivated Sequence can help you achieve your **"call to action"** goal in your persuasive communication.

Step 1	**Attention**	Get your audience to listen.
Step 2	**Need**	Get your audience to feel a need or want.
Step 3	**Satisfaction**	Tell your audience how to fill their need or want.
Step 4	**Visualization**	Get your audience to see benefits of solution.
Step 5	**Action**	Get your audience to take an action.

Monroe's Motivated Sequence

Monroe's Motivated Sequence can help you achieve your **"call to action"** goal in your persuasive communication.

Step 1	**Attention**	"I want to hear what you have to say."
Step 2	**Need**	"I agree. I have that need/want."
Step 3	**Satisfaction**	"I see that your solution will work."
Step 4	**Visualization**	"This is a great idea."
Step 5	**Action**	"I want it."

Monroe's Motivated Sequence

Attention

- **Grab the audience's attention with a thought-provoking statement or question.**

"Imagine a man who has spent decades on death row for a crime he didn't commit. After his execution, new evidence reveals his innocence. How many more innocent lives will be lost before we reconsider the death penalty?"

Monroe's Motivated Sequence

Need

- **Define the problem and explain why it matters. Here, you establish why the audience should care about the issue.**

"The death penalty not only risks executing innocent people, but it also perpetuates racial and socioeconomic biases. Studies have shown that those who are poor or from minority backgrounds are more likely to be sentenced to death, regardless of their actual guilt."

Monroe’s Motivated Sequence

Satisfaction

- **Offer a solution to the problem you've identified. Provide a clear, actionable course of action to resolve the issue.**

"We must abolish the death penalty. By replacing it with life imprisonment without parole, we can protect innocent individuals from wrongful executions while ensuring that those who commit the most heinous crimes are still held accountable."

Monroe's Motivated Sequence

Visualization

- **Help the audience visualize the positive outcomes of the solution, or the negative outcomes if the problem persists.**

"Imagine a justice system where mistakes are not irreversible, where no one is wrongfully executed, and where everyone receives a fair trial, regardless of their background. We can create a more humane, just society where the law truly serves the people."

Monroe's Motivated Sequence

Action

- **Encourage the audience to take action or adopt a new way of thinking about the issue.**

"I urge you to support the abolition of the death penalty in our state. Contact your legislators, vote for candidates who advocate for reform, and stand up for a fairer, more just system. Together, we can end this irreversible injustice."

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